

SDG Goal 16	Peace, justice and strong institutions
SDG Target 16.5	Substantially reduce corruption and bribery in all their forms
SDG Indicator 16.5.1	Proportion of persons who had at least one contact with a public official and who paid a bribe to a public official, or were asked for a bribe by those public officials, during the previous 12 months
Time series	Population who had the impression that public officials were corruptible during their interactions with public authorities in the previous two years

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: June 19, 2023
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/16-5-1>
- Definition: The time series shows the proportion of the population who, in their interactions with public authorities over the previous two years, had the impression that public officials were corruptible. It measures the proportion of respondents in the Lebenslagenbefragung (Life Situations Survey) who agreed with the statement: "In the course of dealing with my matter, I gained the impression that public officials of the [authority] were corruptible." The response scale ranges from "strongly agree" and "tend to agree" through "neither agree nor disagree" to "tend to disagree" and "strongly disagree".
- Disaggregation: Sex

2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: July 2024
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-16-05-01.pdf>
- The time series is not compliant with the UN metadata, but provides additional information.

It is based on respondents' perception that public officials are corruptible, rather than on people who actually paid a bribe or were asked to pay one. Moreover, it covers a two-year reference period rather than one year.

3. Data description

- The data is based on a special evaluation of the Life Situations Survey commissioned by the Federal Government and conducted by the Federal Statistical Office.

(1) Number of people surveyed:

2015: 5,666

2017: 5,965

2019: 6,016

2021: 6,081

(2) Number of companies surveyed:

2015: 1,572

2017: 2,023

2019: 2,679

2021: 2,591

4. Access to data source

- Not available.

5. Metadata on source data

- General information on the Life Situation Survey (only available in German):
https://www.amtlich-einfach.de/DE/Hintergrund/Zufriedenheitsbefragung/Zufriedenheitsbefragung_node.html

6. Timeliness and frequency

- Timeliness: Not available.
- Frequency: Every 2 years

7. Calculation method

- Unit of measurement: Percentage
- Calculation: Not available.

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SDG Indicator 16.5.1	Proportion of persons who had at least one contact with a public official and who paid a bribe to a public official, or were asked for a bribe by those public officials, during the previous 12 months
Time series	Private persons (donors) suspected in the context of corruption offences

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: July 16, 2026
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/16-5-1>
- Definition: This time series shows the number of private persons suspected of having given a bribe in the context of corruption offences.
- Disaggregation: Not available.

2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: July 2024
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-16-05-01.pdf>
- The time series is not compliant with the UN metadata, but provides additional information.

It covers only private persons acting in the context of a personal matter. Persons who committed bribery in their capacity as employees of a business or in another professional capacity are not included. It also includes persons whose attempt to bribe a public official was unsuccessful because they encountered an official who was unwilling to accept the bribe. By contrast, the UN metadata explicitly exclude attempted bribery from the indicator.

3. Data description

- The data is taken from the “Federal Situation Report on Corruption” (Bundeslagebericht Korruption), a corruption statistics report compiled by the Bundeskriminalamt. The data is based on information provided by the state criminal police offices (Landeskriminalämter).

For the data collection for the 2016 Federal Situation Report on Corruption, the classification of cases was restructured. As a result, private persons who could not be assigned to a specific economic sector were no longer recorded under a separate category for “private persons”. This led to a marked increase in the figures reported under “Other” in 2016. The requirement was therefore reversed for the 2017 Federal Situation Report on Corruption, and private persons could again be recorded under the activity category, now using the new designation “private matter”.

4. Access to data source

- Federal Situation Report on Corruption (only available in German):
https://www.bka.de/DE/AktuelleInformationen/StatistikenLagebilder/Lagebilder/Korruption/korruption_node.html

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6. Timeliness and frequency

- Timeliness: t + 9 months
- Frequency: Annual

7. Calculation method

- Unit of measurement: Number
- Calculation:

$$\text{Private persons (donors) suspected} = \frac{\text{Suspected donors total [number]}}{\text{Proportion donors with private matters [\%]}}$$